

Working Title: YOKED (MVP)

Revision note: pricing in Section 6.1 corrected 2026-07-24 to reconcile with the FRD (Yoked_FRD_MVP_Growth_Strategy.pdf). Premium is \$9.99/mo; Verified+ is \$14.99/mo. This is now the single source of truth for pricing.

1. Product Overview & Vision

1.1 Overview

Yoked is a purpose-built relationship and marriage-oriented mobile application focused on intentional, faith-centred relationships for members of the Church of Christ and broader conservative Christian communities. Unlike general dating apps, Yoked prioritizes spiritual alignment and “marriage-mindedness” as the primary metrics for success.

1.2 Vision Statement

To build the most trusted Christian relationship ecosystem where believers form spiritually aligned relationships that lead to healthy marriages and Christ-centered homes.

1.3 Core Philosophy

- bullet Faith-first platform
- bullet Serious relationships over casual dating
- bullet Community accountability
- bullet Trust through verification
- bullet Scripture-aligned culture

1.4 Long-Term Vision

Transform Yoked from a dating app into a trusted Christian relationship ecosystem supporting courtship, discipleship, mentorship, marriage preparation, and Christian family building.

2. Target Audience & User Personas

2.1 Target Audience

- bullet Church of Christ members
- bullet Christian professionals
- bullet Marriage-minded singles
- bullet Conservative Christian communities
- bullet Diaspora believers

2.2 User Personas

- bullet **The Intentional Single:** A Christian professional looking for a partner who shares specific doctrinal values and is ready for marriage.

- bullet **The Diaspora Believer:** A member of the Church of Christ living abroad seeking a spouse with the same cultural and spiritual background.
- bullet **The Community Mentor:** A church leader or elder who provides accountability and “vouches” for younger members.

3. Functional Requirements & Feature Detail

3.1 Account Types & Authentication

During registration, users must select one of two distinct account types separate from the administrator portal:

- bullet **Matches (Suitors):** Individuals looking to be equally yoked to other believers in holy matrimony.
- bullet **Mentors (Elders, Preachers, Deacons):** Church leadership figures who utilize the platform to verify and attest to the character makeup of intending spouses.

Authentication Methods:

- bullet Email signup/login
- bullet Google/Apple sign in

3.2 Advanced User Profiles

Match Profiles (Suitors): Designed to showcase a user's core identity, spiritual depth, and background. Profiles include the following required fields:

- bullet **Core Demographics:** Age, Location, Gender, Blood group, Genotype, Nationality, Qualification, and Occupation.
- bullet **Photos:** User-uploaded profile images.
- bullet **Bio and Values:** A personal description outlining the user's background, personality, and values.
- bullet **Marriage Intentions:** Explicit declaration of the user's timeline and outlook on marriage.
- bullet **Church Affiliation:** Users must select their specific congregation and church affiliation.
- bullet **Doctrinal Alignment:** Selection of specific "Spirituality Markers" to ensure alignment on core beliefs within the MVP.
- bullet **The "Life Verse":** A mandatory profile field for a favorite scripture, serving as the primary conversation starter.

Verification Badges:

- bullet **Level 1 (ID):** Government-issued ID check to ensure the user is real.
- bullet **Level 2 (Church):** A badge granted after a manual or automated check of the user's specific congregation affiliation.

Mentor Profiles (Elders, Preachers, and Deacons): Designed to establish community trust and accountability. Profiles focus on leadership credentials and include:

- bullet **Leadership Credentials:** Official role selection (Elder, Preacher, or Deacon) and verified congregation.
- bullet **Voucher Ledger:** A dedicated sub-dashboard showing pending character reference requests from suitors and spinsters, alongside historical endorsements submitted.

3.3 Intentional Matching Logic (Match Accounts Only)

- bullet **Discovery Engine:** Swipe-based interface with distance and compatibility filters.
- bullet **The “Intentionality Circuit Breaker”** — Active Chat Cap: users are limited to 3 active conversations to prevent “window shopping.” Expiry Rule: conversations with no activity for 72 hours are moved to an “Expired” folder to maintain a high-quality active pool.

3.4 Messaging (Match Accounts Only)

- bullet **Real-time Chat:** Instant text communication built via real-time services.
- bullet **Voice Introductions:** A mandatory 15-second audio snippet required to achieve “Completed Profile” status.

3.5 Community Accountability & Safety

- bullet **Character References:** Match users can invite a “Voucher” via email. The recipient logs into their verified Mentor Account to submit the official one-sentence endorsement attesting to the character makeup of the intending spouse, which then appears publicly on the Match's profile.
- bullet **Reporting & Blocking:** User-facing tools to report policy violations or block problematic users.
- bullet **Safety & Moderation Dashboard:** A dedicated interface for administrators to review reported profiles, manage user behaviour, and verify church badges.

4. User Journey

4.1 Match Journey (Suitors)

- bullet Download app
- bullet Create Match profile (including demographics, life verse, and church affiliation)
- bullet Complete verification & request Mentor character reference
- bullet Discover matches
- bullet Begin conversations
- bullet Develop intentional relationships

4.2 Mentor Journey (Elders, Preachers, Deacons)

- bullet Download app
- bullet Create Mentor profile and verify congregational leadership status
- bullet Receive voucher requests from single believers via email/notification
- bullet Review, verify, and attest to the character makeup of the suitor or spinster
- bullet Maintain ongoing community accountability and guidance

5. Technical & Design Requirements

5.1 System Architecture

Note: superseded for the 72-hour prototype by YOKED_Build_Directives_v2.md (Lovable + Capacitor + Supabase + GitHub Actions). Original PRD baseline retained below for reference.

- bullet Frontend: React Native for a consistent experience on iOS and Android.
- bullet Backend: Node.js with Express for scalable API management.
- bullet Database: PostgreSQL for structured data and complex relationship queries.
- bullet Authentication: Firebase Auth for secure user access control.
- bullet Real-time Services: Socket.IO for instant messaging.
- bullet Hosting: GCP cloud infrastructure.

5.2 Security & Compliance

- bullet **Data Protection:** Implementation of encryption at rest for all personal and spiritual data stored in the database.
- bullet **UGC Moderation:** Integration of automated image filtering to ensure all profile photos align with conservative Christian community standards.

5.3 Visual Identity & Colour Palette (Grounded Growth)

To reflect mature devotion, community accountability, and organic spiritual growth, the user interface utilizes the color-science-backed “Grounded Growth” scheme:

- bullet **Primary Dominant Colour (Burgundy / Deep Wine – #6B1724):** Conveys mature love, deep devotion, and lifelong commitment. Core brand color for headers, main navigation, and primary text elements.
- bullet **Accent & Highlight Colour (Sage Green – #87A987):** Signifies spiritual renewal, growth, and harmony. Applied to Level 1/2 Verification Badges, Character References/Voucher sections, and the “Life Verse” frame.
- bullet **Canvas & Background Colour (Linen – #F4F1EA):** A grounded, warm, earthy neutral providing a premium, clean aesthetic while preventing eye strain.
- bullet **Functional UI States (Muted Terracotta / Ochre – #C97B5A):** Used strictly for the “Intentionality Circuit Breaker” active chat cap indicators and expiration warnings to gently nudge intentional behavior.

6. Monetization & Growth Strategy

6.1 Revenue Model

Primary: Freemium Subscriptions (pricing reconciled 2026-07-24 to match the FRD; this table is authoritative):

- bullet **Free Plan:** Includes basic matching & messaging capabilities for \$0/mo.
- bullet **Premium Subscription (\$9.99/mo):** Includes unlimited messaging, advanced filters, and profile boosts.
- bullet **Verified+ (\$14.99/mo):** Combines premium features with the verified badge and increased visibility.
- bullet **Concierge (\$99+/mo):** Human-led, personalized matchmaking for high-intent professionals.

Premium Feature Set Highlights

Subscribers across premium tiers unlock access to features including:

- bullet Unlimited likes
- bullet Advanced filters
- bullet Read receipts
- bullet Profile boosts
- bullet Verified+ badges
- bullet Event access

Secondary Monetization Streams

- bullet Verification fees
- bullet Local/community events
- bullet Profile boosts (a la carte)
- bullet Counselling partnerships
- bullet Concierge matchmaking upgrades

6.2 Growth Strategy & Launch Phases

- bullet **Phase 1 (Pilot):** Launch within 3-5 specific “seed” congregations within the Church of Christ communities.
- bullet **Phase 2 (Growth):** Leverage success stories, testimonials, and organic referral loops.
- bullet **Phase 3 (Expansion):** Partner with Christian campus ministries, Christian influencers, and partnerships.
- bullet **Phase 4 (Ecosystem):** Expand services into formal mentorship, structured counselling, and community events.

7. Key Success Metrics (KPIs)

- bullet **Monthly Active Users (MAU):** Overall active traffic growth on the platform.
- bullet **Premium Conversion Rate:** Percentage of free users converting to paid structures.

- bullet **Match-to-Message Rate:** Ensuring discovery leads to actual conversation.
- bullet **Verified Profile Ratio:** Aiming for a target of 100% of the user base having at least one form of verification.
- bullet **Retention Rate:** Measure of sustained user engagement over time.
- bullet **Marriage Success Rate:** Tracking users who successfully off-board from the application due to finding a partner ("Off-boarding for Success").